



Arolygiaeth Gofal
Cymru
Care Inspectorate
Wales

Inspection Report

Seren Support Services Ltd (Western Bay)



Seren Support Services Ltd, Llewellyn House Harbourside Business Park,
Harbourside Road, Port Talbot, SA13 1SB



01792952640



www.serensupportservices.co.uk

Date(s) of inspection visit(s):

Service Information:

Operated by:	Seren Support Services Ltd
Care Type:	Domiciliary Support Service
Provision for:	Supported Living
Registered places:	0
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The service provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture, or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:



Well-being

Good



Care & Support

Good



Leadership & Management

Good

Summary:

Seren Support Services Ltd is a domiciliary support service providing support to adults within their own home in the Neath and Port Talbot borough. Overall people experience good well-being. They receive a consistent service overall with a familiar care team at the times agreed. People can continue to remain in their own homes with the support provided and their independence is promoted and encouraged.

People receive good care and support. Personal plans give a good oversight of the person and are developed and reviewed with people. People feel safe and are complimentary about the service they receive. Good relationships and friendships have formed between people and the care staff who support them.

There is good leadership and management in the service. There is a dedicated management team and several departmental leads who all work together to ensure effective service delivery and oversight. Electronic systems are in place to maintain the timeliness of reviewing documentation as well as monitoring the delivery of the service in real time. The Responsible Individual (RI) is visible in the service on a weekly basis and has innovative ways to engage staff with incentives for good performance.

Findings:



Well-being

Good

People live healthily and safely with control over their lives. People are involved in decisions about the care they receive from the onset of assessment through to the routine reviews that take place with them. Personal plans are well written to reflect people's needs and how they prefer support to be given. These are supported by appropriate risk assessments. People are given information about the service and the service user guide and relevant policies and procedures are left with people in their homes to view at any time. The service strives to deliver call times at the preferred times however when this is not possible a compromise is usually met. Communication is generally ok, but this is something the service are working on and hope to improve in due course to enhance people's well-being and satisfaction with the service as a whole.

People are safe and protected from abuse and neglect and are informed about how to raise concerns in a way that suits their communication needs. Care staff complete mandatory safeguarding training as part of their induction when starting work with the service. Those spoken with have a good understanding of their roles and responsibilities to report any concerns they may have about those they support. People told us that they feel 'safe' with the care workers who support them, and all said they feel they would be listened to if they raised any concerns. People have a copy of the services complaint's procedure in their care files which is always accessible to them.

People are supported to cultivate safe and healthy relationships. Compliments were received about the friendliness of care staff by from people receiving support comments included "*they sing to X and its lovely to see their face light up, we're happy with them and he loves them*", "*They have really good banter*" and "*They know what he likes and how he likes things done*". Most people told us they have regular care staff which is important to them and makes them feel confident with the support they get and comfortable in their own homes.



Care & Support

Good

People receive the quality of care and support they need to achieve their personal outcomes. Personal plans are written electronically with printed copies signed and visible in files within people's own homes. Electronic and paper plans viewed were the same and people confirmed that they were involved in the production of them and participate in regular reviews. Personal plans are person centred and are designed to capture "what is important to me" from the persons perspective. Those seen gave a good reflection of the person and good detail for care staff to understand the support to offer people. We visited and spoke with people who confirmed that their personal plans are discussed with them, comments included *"They went through the care plan with us from the onset and we were included"*, *" They come to us to do reviews quite often or sometimes over the phone"* and *"I get regular staff and the care plan does reflect my needs which have been updated"*. The service utilises a software package which has alerts set up to ensure review of care plans are carried out at the quarterly required timescales if not sooner. This ensured they are always up to date with peoples changing needs.

People are protected from harm and abuse. Risk assessments are carried out in people's own homes prior to packages of care commencing which ensure the environment is safe to carry out the task required. The service works with social workers and occupational therapists etc to ensure they can provide the care required safely and the equipment in place is used appropriately. Care staff complete manual handling training and competencies as well as previously mentioned safeguarding training. The service regularly reviews its safeguarding policy which reflects current legislation.

The service are improving their procedures to ensure people's medication is safely managed. There have been issues with medication management in recent months. The service has been transparent with these and have reported them promptly. Due to this, the service is working closely with the local authority and medication management to overcome the issues. At the time of this inspection, the service is actively completing the requirements set out in the action plan from the local authority to ensure medication procedures are robust and errors minimised going forward. Care staff complete medication training and competencies prior to supporting people with medication.

People's risk of infection is minimised by the service provider promoting good hygiene practices, ensuring sufficient supplies are available to meet people's needs. Care staff carry personal protective equipment (PPE) with them, and some are available in people's own homes. We observed care workers using these (gloves and aprons) appropriately and discarding them and washing their hands afterwards as expected. Stocks of PPE are always available from the office.



Leadership & Management

Good

The provider has effective organisational arrangements, governance and oversight to ensure smooth operations in care delivery. The service is currently embedding a new software programme that enhances the management team's ability to oversee the service. The system captures many of the requirements to monitor the service and has multiple alerts features on it. These alerts cover all aspects of the service requiring reviewing, updating or changing which ensures they are kept up to date. Alerts include care plan reviews, staff supervision, training, audits, and more. The provider has similar services in other regions of Wales and benefits from departmental leads within the office who oversee rostering, electronic call monitoring, recruitment, training and more. There is good support available for care staff throughout the day and out of hours through the on-call system whereby a coordinator is on call in the office until all care workers have finished work for the day. There are multiple policies and procedures in place that are reviewed as required to ensure the smooth running of the service. The Statement of purpose (SOP) continues to reflect the service well. The RI is visible in the service regularly and speaks with people and staff to obtain their feedback to drive improvements. We viewed the feedback reports as well as the bi-annual quality of care review which gives a good oversight of what the service is doing well and any improvements that are needed.

People are supported by care staff with the necessary expertise, skills, and qualifications to meet people's care and support needs. We viewed care worker personnel files and found documentation for safe recruitment in place. This includes reference checks, identification and up to date Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) checks. Almost all care staff are registered with Social Care Wales, the workforce regulator. Training records indicate good levels of training across the workforce. Care workers receive regular supervision; however, these were not easily accessible due to the transfer over to new software systems. The new supervision documentation is more robust than previously used and allows more open discussion between the employee and supervisor. Annual appraisals take place. Most care workers feel valued and supported in their roles, comments included *"I like working here, it's fun, everyone is so nice"*, *"the manager is very supportive, the best one I've ever had in social care"* and *"I've received full support within my role and had lots of training prior to starting"*. some staff did feedback that more support could be given, and the RI is hoping to address this in staff engagement going forwards.

People are supported by staff who have sufficient time to support them effectively. We looked at electronic care logs and care records which indicate care staff support people with their needs in the times allocated for calls. People also confirmed that they did not feel rushed during their care visits, and they were satisfied with the care as a whole and did not feel the need to complain about any aspect of the service.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Welsh Government © Crown copyright 2025.

You may use and re-use the information featured in this publication (not including logos) free of charge in any format or medium, under the terms of the Open Government License. You can view the Open Government License, on the National Archives website or you can write to the Information Policy Team, The National Archives, Kew, London TW9 4DU, or email: psi@nationalarchives.gov.uk You must reproduce our material accurately and not use it in a misleading context.